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MOHAMMAD VISITS ZAYED EDUCATIONAL COMPLEX IN AL WARQA'A

His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, visited the Zayed Educational Complex in Al Warqa'a yesterday. Shaikh Mohammad said the school embodied the progress of the UAE's education system. He reaffirmed that national identity, sports, and economic awareness are essential pillars of the modern educational experience, shaping well-rounded, future-ready generations.

SEE ALSO P4

Indian ePassport: Who should apply

Here's what is mandatory and different from a regular passport

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Indian expats in the UAE now have access to chip-embedded ePassport through a new online portal, but they need not replace their existing passports with the new technology-enabled version.

According to India's Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), all passports issued by the Gov-

ernment of India will continue to remain valid till their expiry date. "As and when a respective Passport Office is technically enabled for issuance of ePassport, the citizens applying under that passport office will get the ePassport," the ministry said.

Phase-wise roll-out

India had launched a phase-wise roll-out of ePassport covering all Passport Offices across the country and in its missions abroad. The missions in the UAE started a pilot programme a while ago and are now ready to roll out the implementation, sources told *Gulf News*.

An ePassport is a combined

paper and electronic passport with a Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) chip and an antenna embedded as an inlay of the passport that contains the personal particulars and biometric information of the passport holder. The ePassport will be visually identifiable as a small additional gold-colour symbol printed on the front cover of the passport, towards the bottom.

The passport numbering system has also changed in the ePassport. While existing passports follow the format of one letter followed by a seven-digit number, the ePassport number follows the format of two letters followed by a six-digit number.

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SPORT

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Man honoured for saving two girls from drowning

Al Mamzar Lagoon Beach rescue hailed

DUBAI
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

The Sharjah Civil Defence has honoured an Arab man whose quick action and bravery saved the lives of two young girls from drowning at Al Mamzar Lagoon Beach.

Brigadier Yousif Obaid Harmoul Al Shamsi, Director General of Sharjah Civil Defence, and Brigadier Saeed Obaid Rashid Al Suwaidi, Deputy Director General, presented an award to Qasem Mohammad Al Sayed Mahmoud, the young man who courageously rescued the two girls. They praised his quick thinking and selflessness, noting that his courageous actions helped avert what could have been a tragic incident.

Tense moments

Speaking to *Gulf News*, the 25-year-old Egyptian recounted the tense moments that unfolded on Saturday around 8.30pm, when, after finishing work, he had gone to Al Mamzar



Beach to relax. As he sat near the shore, he suddenly heard frantic screams and shouting. Looking around, he saw a young girl struggling in the water, while others called for help. "I heard someone shouting that he needed a swimmer because he couldn't swim himself," Mahmoud said. "I didn't hesitate. I threw my phone and car keys aside and ran into the sea."

He first managed to pull the older girl to safety and then went back for the younger one. Mahmoud, who is 180cm tall, said the water was unexpectedly deep at the rescue spot. "Even at my height, there was no seaboard under my feet," he said. Both girls were released from the hospital yesterday, having fully recovered from the incident.

Green Innovation District launched at Expo City

FIRST GREEN LICENCE TO ATTRACT GLOBAL ECO-DRIVEN FIRMS UNVEILED

DUBAI
BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

The UAE has launched its first Green Innovation District at Expo City Dubai, a landmark initiative that brings together the nation's economic and environmental priorities under one framework for sustainable growth. The project marks a new phase in the country's development strategy, creating a platform for clean technology, research, and entrepreneurship while supporting the transition to a greener economy.

The Green Innovation District is a joint initiative between the Ministry of Economy and Tourism and Expo City Dubai. It will serve as a base for renewable energy ventures, green manufacturing, sustainable mobility, and circular-economy projects. Abdullah Bin Touq Al Marri, Minister of Economy and Tourism, said the launch marks a turning point in UAE's sustainability journey.

Sustainability journey

"Today's announcement marks a new chapter in our country's sustainability journey. It represents the coming together of our economic and environmental goals and our shared belief that the green economy is not a niche agenda, but the next phase of global competitiveness," he said.

Al Marri added that the district will position the UAE as a regional hub for decarbonisation

The Green Innovation District will serve as a base for renewable energy ventures, green manufacturing, sustainable mobility, and circular-economy projects.

and innovation. "It will strengthen the UAE's role in helping the wider region decarbonise by developing products, services, and knowledge that accelerate the energy transition," he said. "Together with Expo City Dubai, we are creating a model that proves sustainability and competitiveness are not opposing forces. They reinforce each other."

As part of the launch, Reem Al Hashimy, Minister of State for International Cooperation and CEO of Expo City Dubai Authority, unveiled the UAE's first Green Licence to attract eco-conscious businesses. "We are proud to announce the UAE's first Green Licence, providing a host of benefits for eco-conscious businesses, and an on-site Green Intellectual Property Office, which will attract innovative enterprises from across the globe," she said.

Al Hashimy added that Expo City Dubai provides the ideal setting for the new district. "Expo City Dubai, a city-wide test bed for nature-first innovations, is the natural home for this groundbreaking initiative," she said.

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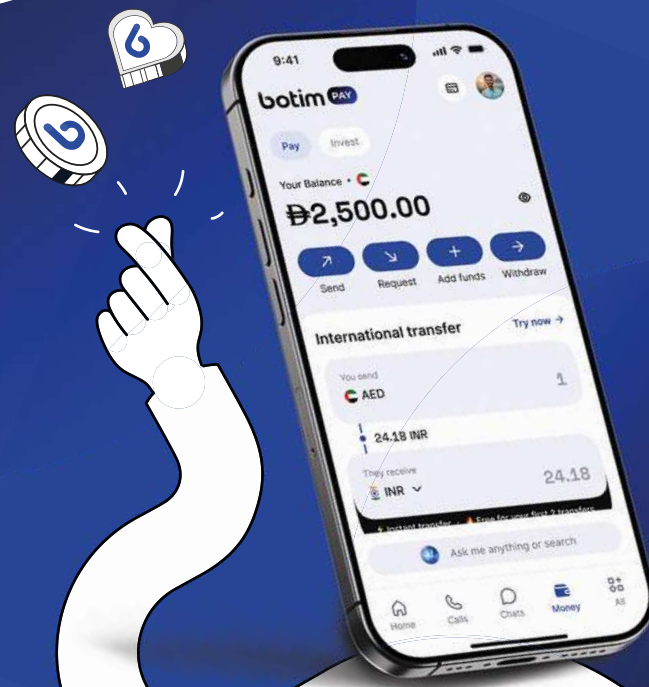
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